Six math clues · answer key

Fingerprints Up Close

Compare tens first, then ones. For rounding, 5 or more ones rounds up.

Math 1 · 52

38 < 52. Compare the tens first, so the greater count is 52.

Math 2 · 71

71 > 67. Compare the tens first, so the greater count is 71.

Math 3 · 45

45 = 45. Both counts match, so the shared count is 45.

Math 4 · 30

34 has 4 ones, so round down to 30.

Math 5 · 90

86 has 6 ones, so round up to 90.

Math 6 · 70

65 has 5 ones, so round up to 70.

Three two-digit comparisons and three nearest-ten roundings. The numbers are for practice, not real fingerprint counts.

Reading & writing · answer key

Fingerprints Up Close

Reading · 1

Ridges carry a thin film of sweat and oil, and a touch copies the ridge pattern onto the glass. Most prints are latent, or hidden.

Reading · 2

Prints form before birth (pads at about 7 to 8 weeks, ridges at about 10 to 11, set by about 15 to 17). Each fingertip grows in its own tiny way, so twins differ.

Reading · 3

Scientists think ridges help us feel fine textures, and maybe wrinkles help grip wet things. Studies on wrinkles disagree, so for now we say maybe.

Writing

Accept a spoken, dictated, drawn, or written sentence about one fingerprint clue.

No two prints have ever been found to match (not a proof). Weeks count from when growth starts (pregnancy weeks run about 2 higher). Twins differ because each fingertip pad grows differently. Scientists think ridges help us feel fine textures; the grip idea is unsettled. Adermatoglyphia, a very rare SMARCAD1 change, means no prints from birth. Powder, ninhydrin and superglue fuming are adult lab work only; kids use pencil graphite and tape. Stay nearby for the wet-marble try and use warm, not hot, water.

Offer dictation: let the child say a complete thought while you write it, then invite a picture or label.

Four fingerprint clues

Fingerprints Up Close

Quiz 1. Which pattern is rarest?

Arches are the rarest. Loops are the most common.

Quiz 2. When is the pattern set?

Prints form before birth, and the pattern is set by about 15 to 17 weeks of growing.

Quiz 3. Who has prints like ours?

Koalas. Their cousins, kangaroos and wombats, do not have prints.

Quiz 4. Why do bath fingers wrinkle?

Your nerves narrow the blood vessels under the skin, and the skin puckers.

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